

SHAHIDH SALIHEEN

Urban Planner | GIS & Spatial Analyst | Research & Data Analyst

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📍 Colombo, Sri Lanka

📁 [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Urban Planning graduate specializing in GIS, Remote Sensing, Spatial Analytics, and Urban Informatics, with a strong ability to leverage geospatial technologies and data-driven approaches to address complex urban, environmental, and infrastructure challenges. Proficient in ArcGIS, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, AutoCAD, SketchUp, Python, and R, with hands-on experience in spatial modelling, transportation planning, land-use analysis, urban research, and decision-support systems. Demonstrated capability in transforming complex spatial data into actionable insights through analytical thinking, research excellence, and problem-solving skills. Passionate about advancing sustainable, resilient, and inclusive urban development by integrating innovative technologies, evidence-based planning practices, and interdisciplinary collaboration to create meaningful impacts on communities and the built environment.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) in Urban Informatics and Planning

2022 – 2026

University of Moratuwa

- CGPA: 3.81
- Dean's List: L1S1, L1S2, L2S3, L3S5, L4S7

Certificate in Foundations of Project Management

2025

- University of Moratuwa

Certificate in Project Scope and Schedule Management

2026

- University of Moratuwa

PROJECTS

INDUSTRY PROJECTS

Drone & Site Survey Projects – Trincomalee, Colombo MC & Ramba Archaeological Site

(Global GIS Pvt Ltd)

- Conducted drone-based, GNSS-supported, and photogrammetric surveys to support land development, municipal planning, infrastructure, and heritage-related projects.
- Processed LiDAR and drone survey data to generate orthomosaics, contour maps, terrain models, and 3D surface models for planning and development assessments.
- Produced GIS-based maps, spatial datasets, and analytical outputs to support site feasibility studies, development planning, and decision-making processes.
- Collaborated with GIS, survey, and planning teams to deliver project reports and technical outputs.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Individually Supervised Site Planning and Design Project

Jan 2026 – May 2026

– REVITALIZING PETTAH: Activating Heritage Through a Structured Market Spine

- Developed a heritage-led urban regeneration proposal for the Old Town Hall and Market Precinct in Pettah, integrating heritage conservation, informal economy management, and multimodal mobility.
- Conducted spatial analysis of pedestrian movement, conflict zones, and future development pressures to inform planning and design decisions.
- Prepared urban design proposals including public realm improvements, adaptive reuse strategies, and a pedestrian-oriented market spine to enhance accessibility, place identity, and urban vitality.
- Produced masterplans, 3D models, visualization renders, and urban design guidelines to communicate proposed interventions and future development scenarios.
- Developed phased implementation strategies, financial feasibility assessments, and PPP-based funding mechanisms to support long-term project delivery.

Individually Supervised Research Project (ISRP) – Night-Time Food Culture Developments, Colombo

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- Conducted spatial, social, and economic analysis of night-time food activity nodes to understand emerging urban dynamics and informal economic systems.
- Collected and analyzed primary data through surveys, stakeholder interactions, and field observations to assess user behavior, accessibility, and operational patterns.
- Applied spatial analytical techniques including Logistic Regression, GWR, and SCCM to identify location patterns, clustering behavior, and growth drivers.
- Produced maps, visualizations, and evidence-based recommendations to support planning and management of night-time urban activities.

Heritage Development Planning – Nuwara Eliya

Jan - March 2025

- Developed a heritage-sensitive planning proposal balancing conservation priorities with urban development needs in Nuwara Eliya.
- Applied GIS-based spatial analysis and Multi-Criteria Decision Making (MCDM) techniques to identify conservation-sensitive areas and development opportunity zones.
- Formulated planning and design guidelines to support controlled development while preserving the town's heritage character and cultural significance.
- Produced spatial plans, suitability assessments, and development recommendations to support sustainable heritage management.

Traffic Analysis using YOLO Object Detection

Jan 2025

- Developed a YOLO object detection model to automate vehicle detection, classification, and traffic counting from video footage.
- Integrated traffic observations into an SQL database for data management and longitudinal analysis.
- Applied R-based visualization and dashboarding techniques to analyse traffic patterns and support evidence-based transport planning.

Regional Planning Project – Human–Elephant Conflict (HEC), Sri Lanka

Sep – Oct 2024

- Conducted spatial and socio-economic analysis of conflict patterns using land-use, environmental, and livelihood data.
- Reviewed the National Physical Planning Policy (NPP) and assessed planning responses to HEC.
- Proposed revised zoning, settlement strategies, and development control measures.
- Prepared livability and conflict-risk maps and evaluated development projects.
- Recommended alternative interventions aligned with ecological sustainability and human safety.

Local Plan – Trincomalee Municipal Council Area

Jan – Mar 2024

- Prepared a development-oriented local plan focusing on tourism-led economic growth, public space enhancement, and community-oriented development.
- Conducted land-use analysis and accessibility assessment to identify suitable zones for leisure, commercial, and public activities.
- Proposed spatial strategies to support long-term urban vitality and local economic activation.

Urban Design & Residential Planning Proposal – Badulupitiya, Badulla

Aug – Sep 2023

- Developed a compact residential planning and design proposal emphasizing efficient land subdivision, walkability, and integration of public and green spaces.
- Applied density, accessibility, and livability principles to optimize land use and enhance residential quality of life.
- Proposed spatial strategies to support long-term urban vitality and detail design proposal.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Intern – Research & Business Development - Global GIS (Pvt) Ltd

Apr - Dec 2025

- Supported GIS, land development, infrastructure, and municipal projects through spatial analysis, field surveys, drone-based data collection, and technical reporting.
- Conducted land-use, accessibility, terrain, and suitability assessments to support site feasibility studies, planning evaluations, and development decision-making.
- Coordinated project datasets, survey outputs, maps, and analytical deliverables across GIS, survey, and planning teams, ensuring timely completion of project milestones.
- Assisted in the preparation of technical reports, maps, presentations, and project documentation for public- and private-sector clients.

- Processed and interpreted spatial datasets, including GNSS, LiDAR, photogrammetry, and drone survey outputs, to generate planning and development insights.
- Supported proposal development, competitor analysis, and client presentations by contributing technical content and spatial evidence.
- Utilized ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, AutoCAD Civil 3D, Pix4D, and 3D Survey to deliver project outputs within multidisciplinary project environments.

Architectural Assistant – AIDA Design Studio

Apr – Oct 2025

- Assisted in the preparation of architectural drawings, spatial layouts, and 3D models for residential and commercial development projects.
- Developed design visualizations using AutoCAD, SketchUp, and Enscape to support concept development and client communication.
- Supported design refinement and revisions based on planning considerations, site constraints, and client requirements.
- Coordinated with architects during design development stages to ensure consistency between planning objectives and architectural outcomes.

Freelance Designer – Urban Development Project

Jan 2023 & Dec 2024

- Supported planning and visualization of an commercial land development project & heritage redevelopment project.
- Prepared site layouts, AutoCAD plans, SketchUp massing models, and Renderings.
- Assisted in identifying suitable spatial arrangements to maximize accessibility and commercial functionality.

Freelance Transcriber (Tamil to English)

Oct 2023 & Nov 2024

- Transcribed Tamil audio recordings into English, ensuring accuracy and cultural context for clear understanding.
- Completed projects efficiently and met client specifications, enhancing skills in bilingual transcription and translation.
- Skills: Transcription, translation, language proficiency (Tamil & English), attention to detail.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Research & Analysis

- Research Design & Data Collection
- Quantitative & Qualitative Analysis
- Spatial Analysis & Interpretation
- Data Visualization
- Technical Report Writing
- Evidence-Based Decision Making

GIS & Planning

- GIS Mapping & Spatial Analysis
- Remote Sensing Applications
- Land Use & Accessibility Analysis
- Site Suitability Assessment
- Urban & Regional Planning
- Development Planning & Policy Analysis

Project & Coordination

- Project Coordination & Documentation
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Cross-functional Collaboration
- Project Monitoring & Reporting
- Workflow & Timeline Management
- Presentation Development

Leadership & Professional Skills

- Analytical Problem Solving
- Communication & Presentation
- Adaptability & Continuous Learning
- Teamwork & Leadership
- Attention to Detail
- Professional Conduct

EXPERTISE

- **Productivity Tools:** Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Nvivo
- **Collaboration & Documentation Tools:** Microsoft SharePoint, Google Documents, Canva
- **GIS & Spatial Analysis :** QGIS, ArcMap, ArcGIS Pro, AutoCAD, AutoCAD Civil 3D, SketchUp, GEE
- **Technical & Surveying Tools:** GNSS/GPS, 3D Survey, PIX4D, LiDAR data processing
- **Data Analysis & Statistics:** R, Python (basic), SPSS, Microsoft Excel

LANGUAGES

Tamil: **Native** Sinhala: **Proficient** English: **Proficient**

MEMBERSHIPS

- **Student Member** – Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka *Present*
- **Batch Representative** - Semester 8 T&CP 21st Batch *2026*
- **Batch Representative** - Majlis-Ul-Islam, University of Moratuwa *2022 - 2026*

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Translator** – Town & Country Planning Students’ Society *2024 - 2025*
- **Football Player** - Team Captain (School) *2014 - 2015*

REFERENCES

Dr. Rizvi Noordeen (PhD, UK)

- Senior Lecturer, Head of the Department
- Department of Town & Country Planning, University of Moratuwa
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Plnr.Y. Arthy

- Assistant Director (Town Planning)
- Urban Development Authority, Battaramulla.
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